

CrewmateMD11 — User Manual

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CrewmateMD11 — User Manual

CrewmateMD11 is a virtual First Officer companion for the **McDonnell Douglas MD11** in Microsoft Flight Simulator. It listens to your voice, responds with audio callouts, runs automated cockpit flows, and guides you through interactive checklists — just like a real crew member.

 Crewmate avatar

Getting Started

Requirements

- Install **an English** Windows speech recognition language pack (Settings → Time & language → Speech). Regional variants (e.g. US, UK, Australia, India) are supported — whichever English recognizer Windows exposes. If several English packs are installed, the active engine follows Windows' installed-recognizer order.
- **Set up Windows Speech Recognition once** before using the Voice Trainer. The trainer teaches Windows your voice, and Windows needs an existing speech profile to train. If the setup has never been run, there is no profile and training cannot start.
- To use the trainer app, set your Display Language to EN-US while training (you can change it back afterward).

Voice Modes

CrewmateMD11 supports two voice recognition modes, chosen with **Voice Mode** in Settings:

Mode	How it works
Always listening	The microphone is always listening. Speak naturally.
Push-to-talk	The FO only listens while you hold the PTT button . Keep holding until you finish the command, then release.

The mic button on the toolbar is the master switch in both modes. When it is off the FO hears nothing, even with PTT held. The icon shows what the FO can hear:

Toolbar mic	Meaning
Crossed out	Off. The FO hears nothing.
Red	Always listening. The FO hears everything.
Faded red	Push-to-talk, ready. Hold the PTT button to speak.
Green	Push-to-talk, PTT held. The FO is listening.

PTT and Mic On/Off Buttons

Both buttons can be a keyboard key, mouse button 4 or 5, or a button or hat on a joystick, yoke, throttle or game controller. They work while MSFS has focus, including in fullscreen.

- **PTT Button**: hold to talk in Push-to-talk mode.
- **Mic On/Off**: works like clicking the toolbar mic, in either mode. It only works while the sim is connected.

To set one, open **Settings** → **Microphone**, click **Set** and press the key or button. Press **Esc** or click **Cancel** to stop without changing it, and click **x** to clear it.

CrewMate does not take the key or button away from MSFS, so pick one that is not bound to anything in the sim. Analog triggers and axes cannot be bound.

Voice Settings

Setting	What it does
Input Device	Which microphone the speech engine listens to.
Sound Volume	How loud the FO's audio is (0–200; above 100 amplifies).
Voice Sensitivity	How confident the engine must be before accepting a command (50–100). Lower is more tolerant and may accept the wrong command; higher is stricter.
Voice Mode	Always listening or Push-to-talk . See Voice Modes .
PTT Button	The key or button held to talk in Push-to-talk mode.
Mic On/Off	A key or button that switches the mic on and off, like the toolbar mic.

Tutorial

Assumptions

This tutorial assumes you are parked at the gate with engines off. You are the Captain and PF (Pilot Flying); CrewMate acts as PM (Pilot Monitoring).

Typical preflight timeline (example)

- 50 min: Crew arrives at aircraft and FO takes his/her seat.
- 47 min: FO starts his/her cockpit preparation before IRS aligned.
- 45 min: FO goes out for walkaround. CA starts setting up FMS and doing his/her cockpit preparation.

```
CA COCKPIT PREPARATION:  
SET GLARESHIELD  
TEST OXYGEN MASK  
CAGE STANDBY ADI  
SET SISP TO IRS AUX AND CHECK APPROPRIATE INDICATIONS, SET SISP BACK TO 1  
SETUP AUDIO
```

- 33 min: FO returns from walkaround and starts the 2nd part of the cockpit preparation.
- 25 min: PF briefs the departure.
- 15 min: PF and PM do the Final cockpit preparation procedure.

```
CA FINAL COCKPIT PREPARATION:  
SET DAF WHEEL  
SETUP FCP (SPEED VCL>250 OR 250>VCL, RUNWAY HEADING, INTIAL CLIMB)  
DO THE COCKPIT PREPARATION CHECKLIST
```

- 10 min: PF calls for the Cockpit Preparation Checklist.
- 1 min: CrewMate closes the cockpit door. PF and PM perform before start flow, after that PF calls for

```
CA BEFORE START PROCEDURE:  
AUX HYD PUMP 1 ON  
SET PARKING BRAKES  
CALL PUSH VIA WHATEVER ADDON YOU USE  
SET ENG IGN TO A OR B (NOT BOTH)  
DO THE BEFORE START CHECKLIST
```

the BEFORE START checklist.

Pushback and Engine Start

- Announce to PM that you are starting engines (e.g., "Starting engine 3). PM only monitors start in this edition of Crewmate.
- As the sequence expected is 3-1-2, you should start engine 2 last because it's used as trigger for after

```
CA AFTER START PROCEDURE:  
VERIFY PUSHBACK IS DISCONNECTED
```

start flow.

- On hand signal from ground personnel, call for the AFTER START checklist.

Taxi

- Announce clear left.

- PM announces when the cabin is ready.
- Check flight controls at a convenient time before or during taxi.
- PM will check the main controls, you check the rudder.
- After the controls check, PM performs the TAXI flow.
- After the 2nd TAXI flow is completed is pressed and a cabin report is received, PF calls for the Taxi

checklist.

CA TAXI PROCEDURE:
ARM SPOILERS
REBRIEF DEPARTURE IF NEEDED
DO THE TAXI CHECKLIST

Line-up & Takeoff

- PF calls for the Line-up flow.
- When line-up clearance is received and the Line-up flow pattern is complete, PF calls for the BEFORE

TAKEOFF checklist.

CA BEFORE TAKEOFF PROCEDURE:
VERIFY EAD GREEN BOX
DO THE BEFORE TAKEOFF CHECKLIST

CA TAKEOFF:
SET 70% N1 THEN CALL AUTOFLIGHT
CHECK THRUST SET
CALL GEAR UP WHEN POSITIVE CLIMB
SPEED ABOVE V_{fr} CALL FLAPS UP
SPEED ABOVE V3 CALL SLATS RETRACT

- When ready to takeoff, set 70% N1 and call Autoflight.

Acceleration

- The After-Takeoff flow is triggered when the aircraft is clean.
- When the aircraft is clean call for the AFTER TAKEOFF checklist to the line.
- When the aircraft is above transition altitude and altimeters are standard call for the AFTER TAKEOFF checklist below the line.

CA AFTER TAKEOFF:
SET ALTIMETERS STANDARD UPON PASSING TRANSITION ALTITUDE

Climb to 10,000 ft

Descent Preparation

- PF should insert landing data in the Landing Plan window.

CA DESCENT PREPARATION:
SET FMS AND MINIMUMS
BRIEF APPROACH
UPON DESCENT DO THE DESCENT APPROACH CHECKLIST THROUGH SEATBELTS

- When aircraft is descending FO will set seat belts on and turn on windshield heating.
- Execute Descent/Approach checklist through seat belts.

10k Descent

Approach

- After passing the transition level and/or setting the barometric reference, complete the

Descent/Approach checklist.

CA APPROACH:
BELOW TL SET ALTIMETERS
EXTEND FLAPS ON SCHEDULE
COMPLETE DESCENT APPROACH CHECKLIST

Landing

- When gear is down, order FO to select an autobrake setting (min/med/max).
- When LDG CONF is set and a cabin report is received, call for the BEFORE LANDING checklist.

CA LANDING:
FLAPS 28 ORDER GEAR DOWN
REQUEST AUTOBRAKE SETTING
DO THE BEFORE LANDING CHECKLIST

- PF announces "Continue" at minima or "Go-around" as appropriate.

After Landing

- Call for clean up when clear of runway to start after landing flow
- If anti-ice is used, flaps will be retracted to 28/EXT.
- Once flows done call for the AFTER LANDING checklist.

CA AFTER LANDING:
ORDER FO TO DO AFTER LANDING FLOW (CLEAN UP)

Parking

- Announce "turning into stand", to trigger PM to turn off the lights.
- Taxi lights off and parking brake on will trigger first part of the Parking flow.
- FO will announce that engines are ready to be shutdown after flow completes.
- Shutting down the engines will trigger the second part of the Parking flow.
- After the Parking flow pattern completes, PM calls for the PARKING checklist.

CA PARKING:
ORDER FO TO TURN OFF LIGHTS (TURNING INTO STAND)
SET PARKING BRAKE

Securing the Aircraft

- After the last passenger leaves (if securing the aircraft), call for the Leaving Aircraft checklist.

Voice Commands

Speak these phrases clearly during flight. The FO uses partial matching — you don't need to be word-perfect, but include the key phrase.

Preflight Timer

Say	What happens
"Let's prepare the aircraft"	Starts the preflight countdown timer to help you track preparation time.

Ground Engineer

Say	What happens
"Ground from cockpit"	Ground Engineer will ask what's your request
"Cockpit to ground"	Ground Engineer will ask what's your request
"Ground from flight deck"	Ground Engineer will ask what's your request

Gear

Say	What happens
"gear down"	Lowers the landing gear. Speed must be at or below 260 knots. Automatically arms spoilers.
"gear up"	Raises the landing gear.

Flaps

The FO will confirm speed limits before moving flaps while airborne.

Say	Flap Setting	Max Speed
"slats retract"	Flaps UP/RET (retracted)	—
"slats extend" or "flaps up"	Flaps UP/EXT	280 kts
"flaps fifteen"	Flaps DAF-15/EXT	255 kts
"flaps twenty eight"	Flaps 28/EXT	210 kts
"flaps thirty five"	Flaps 35/EXT	190 kts
"flaps fifty"	Flaps 50/EXT	175 kts

Engine Anti-Ice

Say	What happens
"Engine anti ice on"	Turns on engine anti-ice for both engines.
"Engine anti ice off"	Turns off engine anti-ice.

Airfoil Anti-Ice

Say	What happens
"Airfoil anti ice on"	Turns on wing and tail anti-ice.
"Airfoil anti ice off"	Turns off wing and tail anti-ice.

Lights (Landing / Taxi / Nose / Strobe)

Say	What happens
"Taxi lights on"	Turns on nose taxi light.
"Taxi lights off"	Turns off nose taxi light.
"Strobe lights on"	Turns on strobes.
"Strobe lights off"	Turns off strobes.

Flight Director

Say	What happens
"Flight Director on"	Activates the Flight Director. (FO only as it's unreachable for FO to turn off captain's)
"Flight Director off"	Deactivates the Flight Director. (FO only as it's unreachable for FO to turn off captain's)

Autopilot

Say	What happens
"Autoflight"	Engages Autopilot. Also activates A/THR for takeoff.
"Set speed <i>or speed select</i> "	Sets commanded speed.
"Set heading _ <i>or heading select</i> _"	Sets commanded heading.
"Set altitude _ or altitude select _ or set flight level <i>or flight level select</i> "	Sets commanded altitude.
"Engage selected speed"	Pulls speed knob to select selected speed.
"Engage heading select"	Pulls heading knob to select selected heading.
"Engage heading hold"	Pushes heading knob to activate heading hold mode.
"Engage nav"	Selects NAV mode.
"Engage land"	Selects LAND mode.
"Engage level change"	Pulls altitude knob.
"Engage profile"	Selects PROF mode.

Flight Controls Check

Say	What happens
"Flight controls check"	Starts the flight controls flow: Up, Down, Left, Right, Rudder Left, Rudder Right

Launching Flows by Voice

Say	Flow launched
"Clear left" or "Left side clear"	Clear Left flow
"Runway entry procedure" or "Clear to line up"	Before Takeoff flow
"Before start procedure"	Before Start flow
"Okay to clean up"	After Landing flow

Launching Checklists by Voice

Say	Checklist launched
"Before start checklist to the line"	Before start to the line
"Before start checklist below the line"	Before start below the line
"After start checklist"	After Start
"Before takeoff checklist to the line"	Before takeoff to the line
"Before takeoff checklist below the line"	Before takeoff below the line
"After takeoff climb checklist to the line"	Climb to the line
"After takeoff climb checklist below the line"	Climb below the line
"Approach checklist"	Approach
"Landing checklist"	Landing
"After landing checklist"	After Landing
"Parking checklist"	Parking
"Secure aircraft checklist"	Secure Aircraft
"Stop checklist" or "Abort checklist" or "Cancel checklist"	Aborts the active checklist

Tips & Troubleshooting

The FO isn't hearing me

- Check that your microphone is selected and working.
- Adjust the **Voice Sensitivity** setting.
- In Push-to-talk mode, check that a **PTT Button** is set and that the toolbar mic turns green while you hold it.

My PTT or Mic On/Off key does nothing while MSFS has focus

- MSFS is probably running as administrator. Run CrewMate as administrator too.

The FO ignores everything I say before departure

- Between T-45 and T-33 on the preflight timer the FO is outside on the walkaround and does not answer. The **FO outside** indicator is shown while this is the case. Ground engineer calls still work.

The FO keeps repeating the challenge

- Your response didn't match the expected phrase. Listen to the challenge and use one of the phrases listed in this manual (voice matching can be tuned in settings).
- If a physical switch must be set first (e.g., parking brake), set it in the cockpit before responding.

The Voice Trainer says training failed

- "Value does not fall within the expected range" means Windows has no speech profile for your account. Run Windows Speech Recognition setup once, then start the trainer again.
- The trainer also needs the Windows Display Language set to EN-US while it runs.

How do I stop a checklist mid-way?

- Say "**Stop checklist**", "**Abort checklist**", or "**Cancel checklist**" at any time.

Can I run flows and checklists manually without voice?

- Yes. Both can be triggered from the **Flows** and **Checklist** panels in the app UI.